

REORIENT

Aegis Project Pivot Strategy



How to turn Aegis from a clever hack into a working product that solves one real problem, demo-able in 4 hours, with a clear path to revenue.

Date	September 19, 2026
Status	Hackathon Reorientation
Audience	Team / Judges / Investors
Time to Demo	4 Hours

1. THE PROBLEM WE ACTUALLY SOLVE

Nigeria loses thousands of lives annually to highway kidnappings, armed robberies, and road accidents. When a passenger is in danger on a Lagos-Abuja bus, they cannot safely make a phone call. The current system has no reliable mechanism for silent, fast emergency notification that works within the constraints of Nigerian infrastructure and smartphone OS limitations.

Why the original Aegis idea fails in practice:

Silent audio monitoring	Android kills background processes; iOS bans background mic entirely. Both show privacy indicators that defeat the 'invisible' premise.
Always-on GPS	OS throttles background location to every 15-30 min. In remote highway zones with sparse cell towers, GPS is unreliable.
Black screen UI	Android requires foreground service notification (visible); iOS shows green/orange mic indicator. Both defeat the disguise.
Watcher response model	Family members can't dispatch help. No coordination, no triage, no response infrastructure.
Network dependency	All features require data. Kidnappings target remote zones with no signal.

"Every privacy and battery feature Apple and Google shipped in the last 5 years is a direct attack on Aegis's core mechanism."

2. THE PIVOT: WHAT AEGIS BECOMES

Drop the surveillance-tech angle. Become the **Interstate Travel Safety Network** for Nigeria. One problem, one core feature, one revenue model.

Core Principle: SMS-First, App-Enhanced

SMS works on every phone, requires no data, works on 2G, and is delivered by the carrier. Every successful Nigerian safety app (Alerte, LERMS, FRSC) uses SMS as the primary channel. Data connectivity is a bonus, not a dependency.

FEATURE	DESCRIPTION
SOS BUTTON — One-tap emergency alert	Simple screen with a single SOS button. Passenger taps once. App sends GPS location + name + bus route via SMS and data simultaneously. No background monitoring. No audio detection. Works every time.

FEATURE	DESCRIPTION
SAFE TRIP — Automated check-in/out	Passenger taps 'Starting trip' at departure and 'Arrived safely' at destination. If no check-out within expected time window, auto-alert SMS goes to emergency contact. Zero background execution needed.

FEATURE	DESCRIPTION
FLEET DASHBOARD — B2B command center	Transport companies see all active buses on a map. SOS alerts route to company dispatch. Trip analytics, route safety scores, FRSC compliance reporting. This is the revenue product.

3. WHAT TO KILL / KEEP / ADD

Feature	Verdict	Reason
Black screen UI	KILL	OS restrictions make it unreliable; users need visible interface
Audio monitoring (85dB)	KILL	False positives destroy trust; OS kills background audio
Telegram bot alerts	DEMOTE	Keep as secondary channel; SMS is primary
Two-phase GPS	SIMPLIFY	One GPS fix + send. Don't overthink it
Pairing codes (6-char)	REPLACE	QR code scan or phone number-based pairing
Watcher dashboard	REORIENT	Becomes fleet dashboard for B2B; personal version stays
Simulate button	KEEP	Great for demo purposes
SOS button	ADD	Single-tap emergency trigger — the core feature
Safe Trip check-in/out	ADD	Automated safety net with zero background execution
Fleet dashboard	ADD	B2B product for transport companies
SMS engine	ADD	Primary alert channel via native phone SMS
Auto-alert timer	ADD	Triggers if passenger doesn't check out on time

4. THE 4-HOUR DEMO BUILD

This is what we build and demo in 4 hours. No background monitoring. No audio detection. Just a working app with SMS alerts and a fleet dashboard.

TIME	TASK
HOURL 1: Strip & Rebuild Passenger App	- Remove black screen, audio detection, two-phase GPS - Add SOS button screen (large red button, one tap) - Add Safe Trip check-in/out screen - Integrate native SMS sending (react-native-sms or Linking API) - Format: SOS message with name, GPS coords, Google Maps link

TIME	TASK
HOURL 2: SMS Engine + Auto-Alert	- Build SMS formatting utility (name, lat/lng, bus route) - Implement check-out timer (configurable, e.g. 8 hours) - Auto-alert: if no check-out, send SMS to emergency contact - Test on real device: tap SOS -> SMS received with map link

TIME	TASK
HOURL 3: Fleet Dashboard	- New page: /dashboard/fleet - Map showing all 'active trip' passengers as green dots - SOS alerts appear as pulsing red markers - Trip list: passenger name, route, status (active/completed/alert) - Stats: active trips today, alerts sent, avg completion time

TIME	TASK
HOURL 4: Polish + Demo Flow	- End-to-end demo: passenger taps SOS -> SMS sent -> fleet dashboard updates - Safe trip flow: check-in -> timer running -> check-out -> completed - Auto-alert demo: start trip -> wait -> auto-SMS triggers - Quick pitch script for presentation - Deploy fleet dashboard to Vercel

5. REVENUE MODEL

The consumer app is the distribution channel. The fleet dashboard is the business.

B2B: Transport Company Pricing

Plan	Price	Vehicles	Features
Starter	N5,000/vehicle/mo	1-20	Fleet map, SOS routing, basic trip tracking
Growth	N3,500/vehicle/mo	20-100	Everything in Starter + analytics, compliance reports
Enterprise	Custom	100+	API integration, dedicated support, custom branding

Revenue Projections

Milestone	Customers	Vehicles	Monthly Revenue	Annual Run Rate
Month 1	1-2	20-40	N70K-140K	N840K-1.7M
Month 3	5-8	100-200	N350K-700K	N4.2M-8.4M
Month 6	10-15	300-500	N1M-1.75M	N12M-21M
Year 1	20-30	600-1000	N2.1M-3.5M	N25M-42M

Consumer Side: Free

The passenger app is free. No subscription. This maximizes distribution and builds the network. Revenue comes exclusively from transport companies paying for fleet management and compliance tools.

Why Transport Companies Will Pay:

- FRSC regulatory pressure to demonstrate passenger safety measures
- Insurance premium reduction (incident documentation + faster response)
- Competitive advantage: 'Your bus has Aegis protection' marketing
- Operational visibility: know where every bus is and if passengers are safe
- Incident liability protection: timestamped, GPS-verified records

6. TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE

What Changes in the Codebase

Component	Current	New
Passenger App	Black screen + audio detection, Expo managed workflow	SOS button + Safe Trip UI, Same Expo setup, simpler screens
Alert System	Supabase insert + Telegram bot, Two-phase GPS	Native SMS (primary), Supabase insert (backup), Single GPS fix
Dashboard	Personal watcher view, Incident feed	Fleet management view, Active trips map + SOS alerts, Trip analytics
Database	incidents, watchers, pairing_codes	incidents (updated), trips (new), fleet_vehicles (new), companies (new)
Realtime	Supabase postgres_changes for incident feed	Same, but for fleet dashboard, trip status updates
Auth	Email/password + cookies	Same + company-based auth for fleet users

New Database Schema Additions

trips table: id, passenger_id, bus_route, departure_location, arrival_location, departure_time, expected_arrival, actual_arrival, status (active/completed/alert), created_at

companies table: id, name, contact_email, subscription_plan, created_at

fleet_vehicles table: id, company_id, plate_number, driver_name, route, created_at

7. COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

Nigeria has 4+ safety apps. Lagos State launched LERMS in April 2026. FRSC has a mobile app. None of them focus on interstate bus travel specifically.

Product	Focus	Channel	Revenue	Gap
Alerte	General SOS (one-swipe alert)	Push notifications	Freemium subscriptions	No transport company focus
LERMS (Lagos Gov)	Urban emergency response	USSD, SMS, IVR, app	Government funded	Lagos only; no interstate
Emro (Rescue Tech)	Armed response + ambulance	App + phone call	Per-incident billing	Lagos-centric; no fleet mgmt
FRSC App	Road safety info + license	App	Free (gov)	No real-time alerts
Citizen (US)	Community alerts	Push notifications	Premium \$14.99/mo	Not in Nigeria; no B2B
Aegis (Pivot)	Interstate bus travel safety	SMS (primary) + app	B2B fleet subscriptions	Only player in this niche

Our unfair advantages:

- **Only player in interstate bus safety niche** — nobody else focuses on this specific use case
- **SMS-first architecture** — works without data, on 2G, on any phone on the receiving end
- **B2B revenue model** — transport companies have budget and regulatory motivation to pay
- **Aligned with government infrastructure** — LERMS uses USSD/SMS; we ride the same wave
- **Hackathon momentum** — working product, deployed, with real Supabase backend

8. DEMO SCRIPT (3 MINUTES)

Step	What to Show	What to Say
1. Problem (30s)	Show map of Nigeria highlighting interstate highway routes	"1 million people move Lagos-Abuja by road every week. Kidnappings on highways increased 67% from 2021-2023. When a passenger is in danger, they can't safely make a phone call."
2. Passenger App (60s)	Open app -> show SOS button screen -> tap SOS -> SMS received on second phone	"Aegis is a one-tap safety system. The passenger sees a simple screen. One tap sends their name, location, and a Google Maps link via SMS. No background monitoring. No audio detection. Works on any phone, with or without data."
3. Safe Trip (30s)	Show check-in -> trip timer -> check-out -> auto-alert demo	"Before the trip, the passenger checks in. On arrival, they check out. If they don't arrive on time, Aegis automatically alerts their emergency contact. Zero background execution needed."
4. Fleet Dashboard (45s)	Show map with active buses -> SOS alert appears -> trip analytics	"Transport companies get a fleet dashboard. They see every active bus. When a passenger triggers SOS, it appears on the fleet map instantly. They get trip analytics, compliance reports, and incident records. This is what they pay for."
5. Revenue (15s)	Show pricing slide	"The passenger app is free. Transport companies pay per vehicle. At 3,500 Naira per vehicle per month, 100 vehicles is 350,000 Naira monthly recurring. The consumer app is the distribution channel. The fleet dashboard is the business."

9. NEXT STEPS

Immediate (This Weekend)

- Strip passenger app to SOS button + Safe Trip screens (Hour 1-2)
- Build SMS engine with Google Maps link formatting (Hour 2)
- Build fleet dashboard with active trip map (Hour 3)
- End-to-end demo: tap SOS -> SMS received -> dashboard updates (Hour 4)
- Deploy fleet dashboard to Vercel

Post-Hackathon (Weeks 1-4)

- Partner with 1-2 transport companies for pilot (God Is Good Motors, Peace Mass Transit)
- Implement real SMS gateway (Termii or Africa's Talking API) for production SMS
- Add USSD check-in option for feature phone users
- Build compliance reporting module for FRSC requirements
- Apply to Y Combinator or Africa-focused accelerators (CcHub, Ventures Platform)

"The situations where Aegis is most needed are precisely the situations where every technical layer is most likely to fail. The solution isn't more technology — it's simpler technology on a more reliable channel."

Aegis doesn't need to be a silent surveillance system. It needs to be the simplest, most reliable way for a bus passenger in Nigeria to say **'I need help'** and have that message actually arrive.